

Henry Sohre Kitiabi, PhD, MPH

Epidemiologist | Infectious Disease and Aging Epidemiology | Claims-Based and Multilevel Analysis

Department of Population Health and Pathobiology, College of Veterinary Medicine, North Carolina State University, Raleigh, NC

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EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy, Epidemiology and Biostatistics

August 2025

University of Georgia, College of Public Health, Athens, GA

Dissertation: *An Evaluation of HIV Risk, Testing, and a Review of PrEP Awareness, Willingness, and Attitudes Among US Adolescents and Young Adults*

Graduate Certificate in Global Health

May 2024

Global Health Institute, University of Georgia, Athens, GA

Master of Public Health, Epidemiology and Biostatistics

May 2020

Georgia State University, School of Public Health, Atlanta, GA

Thesis: *Predictors of TB Mortality Among ART-Naïve HIV-Positive Children in Kenya*. Fulbright Foreign Student Fellow.

Bachelor of Science, Biochemistry (Minor: Zoology)

December 2012

Kenyatta University, Nairobi, Kenya. Second Class Honors, Upper Division.

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Postdoctoral Research Fellow

January 2026 – Present

Department of Population Health and Pathobiology, College of Veterinary Medicine, North Carolina State University, Raleigh, NC (Advisor: Dr. Sarah Rhea)

Graduate Research Assistant, Department of Epidemiology and Biostatistics

January 2020 – May 2025

College of Public Health and Global Health Institute, University of Georgia, Athens, GA

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Department of Epidemiology and Biostatistics

January 2025 – May 2025

College of Public Health, University of Georgia, Athens, GA

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Epidemiology of Alzheimer's disease and related dementias and of healthcare-associated infections in long-term care; infectious disease epidemiology (TB, HIV, COVID-19); adolescent HIV prevention and testing; multilevel and causal analyses of large administrative claims data; One Health surveillance.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Postdoctoral Research Fellow, North Carolina State University

January 2026 – Present

Rhea Epidemiology Lab, Department of Population Health and Pathobiology, College of Veterinary Medicine, Raleigh, NC

- Lead analyst for a claims-based multilevel study of Alzheimer's disease and related dementias (ADRD) and urinary tract infection, conducted under a CMS Data Use Agreement, covering approximately 1.85 million Medicare skilled nursing facility (SNF) stays nested within approximately 14,400 facilities and 3,144 counties.
- Built the full analytic pipeline in R: linkage of MedPAR, MDS, LTCFocus, Payroll-Based Journal, and CDC/ATSDR Social Vulnerability Index data through an SSA-to-FIPS crosswalk; ICD-10-CM case definitions for ADRD (CCW and Bynum algorithms) and tiered UTI outcomes; Elixhauser comorbidity scoring; and three-level mixed-effects logistic regression (glmmTMB) with ICC decomposition, change-in-estimate confounder screening, and effect-modification testing.
- Developing a protocol for a complementary machine-learning arm (gradient-boosted trees with facility-grouped cross-validation) to be evaluated for discrimination, calibration, and subgroup fairness.

- Leading a 29-study scoping review of ADRD and healthcare-associated infections using a standardized, infection-site-specific extraction protocol.
- Developed a tiered missing-data flagging strategy and multiple-imputation decision rules for a facility-level (LTCFocus) analytic plan.
- Manuscripts from the primary ADRD-UTI analysis are in preparation.

Graduate Research Assistant, Biostatistical Consulting Center (B3C)

January 2025 – May 2025

Department of Epidemiology and Biostatistics, University of Georgia, Athens, GA

- Designed and implemented the center's research operations systems, including survey administration (QuestionPro), automated data capture (Microsoft Dataverse and Power Automate), and project tracking and invoicing workflows (Microsoft 365).
- Led development of the center's webpage in collaboration with UGA IT.

Graduate Research Assistant, Crisis Pregnancy Center Map Study

January 2023 – December 2024

Department of Epidemiology and Biostatistics, University of Georgia, Athens, GA

- Updated and verified the national Crisis Pregnancy Center database across all 50 states and resolved data discrepancies in REDCap, enabling on-time public release of the 2024 dataset for epidemiological research.

Graduate Research Assistant, Tuberculosis Transmission Studies

January 2020 – December 2022

Global Health Institute, University of Georgia, Athens, GA

- Processed and analyzed TB transmission data from Uganda in R, integrating wearable-sensor contact data with geospatial data to identify transmission hotspots (factor analysis, $n = 75$).
- Co-developed the methodology for a nested case-control study of TB-naïve individuals, which was subsequently funded (2024).
- Coordinated weekly meetings with field teams in Uganda to monitor data collection and resolve data-quality issues.
- Conducted literature reviews supporting manuscript development on TB transmission frameworks.

Health Equity Fellow, Metro-Atlanta Wellbeing Project

October 2022 – May 2023

Health Equity Hub, College of Public Health, University of Georgia, Athens, GA

- Partnered with the City of Clarkston, GA, to design data-informed strategies to improve access to food, healthcare, and housing services for residents with limited English proficiency; developed a Swahili audiovisual navigation tool that increased engagement among non-English speakers by 40%.

Data Analysis and Resource Mobilization Intern, CARE International

June 2019 – December 2019

Food and Nutrition Security Department; Sexual and Reproductive Health and Rights Department, Atlanta, GA

- Analyzed baseline and endline survey data from a Bangladesh nutrition program (SPSS; descriptive statistics, regression, ANOVA) and produced an analytical report that informed two program redesigns.
- Synthesized 80 program reports from Tanzania, Ethiopia, the DRC, and India into an evidence-based SRHR toolkit and developed a standardized evaluation tool adopted for USAID-funded programs.

PUBLICATIONS AND MANUSCRIPTS

Peer-reviewed publications

Fuller TJ, Leonard M, Cochran J, Hutchins RJ, Brioché R, **Kitiabi H**, Cranmer JN. Collaborative development and implementation of a video-based curriculum expansion to improve refugee women's birth experiences in the United States. *Health Promotion Practice*. 2021;22(2):177–180. PMID: 32253924.

Manuscripts under review

Kehinde OO, Ogunwemimo F, Omobowale OM, Alao OD, Lokossou VK, **Kitiabi HS**, Shen Y, Chen Y, Kebede S, Oluabunwo C, et al. Characterizing forecasting risk communication during the COVID-19 pandemic: a quantitative content analysis of news reports. Under review, *Journal of Interventional Epidemiology and Public Health*.

Lokossou VK, Kehinde OO, Sogbossi LS, Haji-Said A, Chen Y, **Kitiabi HS**, Ohuabunwo C, Antara S, Haley C, Shaikh AT, Olaniran M, Shen Y, Aïss MA, et al. Constraints and enablers to the implementation of e-learning for global health security competency-based training among the public health workforce in 16 West African countries: a mixed-methods study. Under review, *Journal of Interventional Epidemiology and Public Health*.

Kehinde OO, Ogunwemimo F, Omobowale OM, Alao OD, Lokossou VK, **Kitiabi HS**, Shen Y, Chen Y, Kebede S, Ohuabunwo C, et al. Scaling up digital solutions for health security in Africa: a call for pragmatic leadership, research, and policymaking. Under review, *Journal of Interventional Epidemiology and Public Health*.

Manuscripts in preparation

Kitiabi HS, Swartzentruber A, Tamora C, Knight J, Lambert D. Examining temporal trends in self-reported HIV testing among sexually experienced U.S. high school students (YRBS, 2015–2021).

Kitiabi HS, et al., Rhea S. Alzheimer's disease and related dementias and urinary tract infection among Medicare skilled nursing facility residents: a multilevel analysis. Preprint forthcoming on medRxiv.

Kitiabi HS, et al. Healthcare-associated infections among people living with Alzheimer's disease and related dementias: a scoping review of 29 studies.

Kitiabi HS, Malik AA, Njuguna I, Otieno V, Rothenberg R, LaCourse SM, Westbrook A, Cranmer J, Slyker J, Obimbo E, Wamalwa D, John-Stewart G, Cranmer LM. Monocyte-to-lymphocyte ratio predicts TB mortality among ART-naïve hospitalized Kenyan children living with HIV.

Doctoral dissertation and thesis

Kitiabi HS (2025). *An Evaluation of HIV Risk, Testing, and a Review of PrEP Awareness, Willingness, and Attitudes Among US Adolescents and Young Adults*. Doctoral dissertation, University of Georgia, Athens, GA.

Kitiabi H, Cranmer L, Rothenberg R (2020). *Monocyte-to-lymphocyte ratio predicts TB mortality among ART-naïve hospitalized Kenyan children living with HIV*. Master of Public Health thesis, Georgia State University, Atlanta, GA.

Technical reports

Kitiabi H, Jenkins DJ, Khrist R (2019). Assessing the association between anemia and its probable predictors among children and women of reproductive age in Bangladesh. CARE International, Food and Nutrition Security Department, Atlanta, GA (unpublished report).

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Kitiabi HS. Poster presentation. Annual State of the Public's Health Conference, University of Georgia Center for Continuing Education, Athens, GA, October 22, 2025.

Kitiabi HS. Oral presentation. 17th Annual Kenya Students and Scholars Association Conference, Georgia State University, Atlanta, GA, September 5–6, 2025.

Kitiabi HS. Metro-Atlanta Cities Wellbeing Initiative: City of Clarkston. Oral presentation. Georgia Municipal Association Health Equity Fellows Symposium, Atlanta, GA, April 2023.

Kitiabi HS. Oral presentation. Global Health Students' Annual Research Symposium, Global Health Institute, University of Georgia, Athens, GA, April 2021.

HONORS, AWARDS, AND FELLOWSHIPS

Halloran Scholarship, Summer Institute in Statistics and Modeling in Infectious Diseases (SISMID), Emory	March 2026
UGA Graduate School and Departmental Dissertation Research Award	May 2024
UGA Graduate School Dean's Award: Graduate Degree Accelerator	November 2023
Health Equity Fellowship, College of Public Health, University of Georgia	2022 – 2023
Fulbright Foreign Student Fellowship, Georgia State University	2018 – 2020
Governor's Goodwill Ambassador Award, State of Arkansas	August 2018
Second Class Honors, Upper Division, Kenyatta University	December 2012

METHODOLOGICAL AND TECHNICAL SKILLS

Statistical programming: R (primary; tidyverse, glmmTMB, lme4, comorbidity, mice), SAS, SPSS, NVivo

Study design and analysis: multilevel and mixed-effects models, generalized estimating equations, survival analysis, complex-survey analysis (YRBS), DAG-based causal inference, missing-data methods (multiple imputation), Bayesian methods and Markov chain Monte Carlo (MCMC), supervised machine learning

Data sources: Medicare/Medicaid claims (MedPAR, MDS), LTCFocus, Payroll-Based Journal, CDC/ATSDR SVI, YRBS, NHANES, BRFSS; ICD-10-CM coding and algorithm-based phenotyping; CMS Data Use Agreement compliance

Data management: REDCap, QuestionPro, Microsoft Dataverse and Power Automate, Microsoft 365, Google Workspace

Languages: English (fluent), Swahili (fluent)

PROFESSIONAL TRAINING AND CERTIFICATIONS

Summer Institute in Statistics and Modeling in Infectious Diseases (SISMID)	June 2026
<i>Rollins School of Public Health, Emory University, Atlanta, GA</i>	
• Introduction to MCMC (June 22–23, 2026); R Tools for Rapid Outbreak Analytics (June 25–26, 2026)	
Collaborative Institutional Training Initiative (CITI), Human Subjects Research	January 2023
Data and Health Indicators in Public Health Practice, Johns Hopkins University via Coursera	January 2020
Research Data Services Certification in R and SPSS, Georgia State University Library	November 2019

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Graduate Teaching Assistant, EPID 7010 and EPID 7410 (Epidemiology I and II)	Spring 2025
<i>Department of Epidemiology and Biostatistics, University of Georgia, Athens, GA</i>	
• Facilitated semester-long laboratory sections for 61 graduate students in epidemiologic methods and biostatistics. • Mentored 10 EPID 7410 student research groups on study design, methodology, and scientific rigor.	

COURSE DEVELOPMENT AND PEDAGOGICAL TRAINING

Advanced Teaching Certificate, North Carolina State University	June 2026
<i>Graduate School, Teaching Programs (GPA 4.00/4.00)</i>	
Course designed: POH 7117 Digital Health and One Health Surveillance (3 credits)	2026
<i>Advanced undergraduate/graduate course; one of a four-course One Health series</i>	
• Authored the complete syllabus with five Bloom's taxonomy-aligned learning outcomes, an eight-week scaffolded assessment plan, grading rubrics, and a technology-integration plan (AI-based outbreak prediction, GIS mapping, WHO DON and WAHIS datasets).	

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE AND LEADERSHIP

Councilor-elect, HIV/AIDS Section, American Public Health Association (APHA) 2026 – Present

Member, Education and Training Committee

- Develop and distribute educational resources on current HIV/AIDS research, practice, and policy for public health professionals.
- Organize training sessions and workshops for healthcare providers and public health practitioners, in collaboration with partner organizations.

Secretary, Postdoctoral Association, North Carolina State University 2026 – Present

- Record and distribute minutes for board meetings; coordinate Triangle-wide postdoctoral events (Postdoc Appreciation Week; annual Triangle Postdoc Picnic) with counterparts at Duke, UNC-Chapel Hill, and Wake Forest.
- Contributed to revising the NC State PDA bylaws, adopted and published by the Office of Postdoctoral Affairs.

Editor, NC DNA Day Blog

January 2026 – Present

A science blog by students for students at NC Triangle institutions (UNC-Chapel Hill, Duke, and NC State)

- Edited four blog posts.

Electoral Committee Organizing Secretary, African Graduate Students' Forum

January – May 2021

University of Georgia, Athens, GA

- Coordinated the annual executive election for a 150-member organization, including communications, logistics, and documentation of board decisions.

PEER REVIEW

Reviewer, Journal of Medical Internet Research (more than 15 manuscripts) 2024 – Present

Reviewer, Cureus Journal of Medical Science (7 manuscripts) 2021 – Present

Abstract Reviewer, HIV/AIDS Section, APHA Annual Meeting, San Antonio, TX (12 abstracts) 2026

Late-Breaker Abstract Reviewer, Society for Epidemiologic Research Annual Meeting (10 abstracts) 2026

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

American Public Health Association (HIV/AIDS Section) 2022 – Present

Society for Epidemiologic Research 2026 – Present

American Statistical Association 2025 – Present

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT AND PUBLIC HEALTH PRACTICE

HIV Testing, Prevention, and Linkage-to-Care Program Volunteer April 2025 – Present

Clarke County Health Department, Athens, GA

- Register clients for HIV/STI testing, counsel on PrEP/PEP eligibility using CDC materials, and link reactive results to care within 48 hours through coordinated referrals.

COVID-19 Program Associate, Community Organized Relief Effort (CORE)

June – September 2020

Alpharetta, GA

- Operated a high-volume testing site serving more than 200 clients daily; managed epidemiological data for Fulton County Board of Health reporting and contact tracing; redesigned workflows that reduced wait times by 25%.